

Lecture 23 — RREF, pivots, free variables, and software

Fri Oct 16

Last updated: August 18, 2026.

The class outline for this day will be posted before class.

Reading: RREF/software solvers and Lachniet Ch. 2. Related objectives: [Lectures](#).

Learning objectives

By the end of class, students should be able to:

1. Interpret reduced row echelon form.
2. Identify pivot and free variables.
3. Describe a solution set parametrically.
4. Distinguish inconsistent, unique, and infinite-solution cases.
5. Use software to solve or row-reduce a system and verify the answer using a residual.